BOSS & FRIENDS
CONSTRUCTION LTD.

FREE CREW PACK

5 FIVE-MINUTE TOOLBOX TALKS

Read one out at the start of the day, ask the question at the bottom, and get everyone to sign the sheet on page 2. Five minutes, no slides, done before the first coffee's cold.

FOREMEN & LEAD HANDS | APPRENTICES | ANY TRADE ON A CONCRETE SITE

01 WET CONCRETE BURNS

POUR DAYS

Wet concrete is strongly alkaline. It can cause chemical burns that don't hurt until hours later, when the damage is already done.

- Wear waterproof gloves, and boots with your pants **over** the top, not tucked in.
- Wear eye protection on the hose, screed and finishing.
- Don't kneel in wet concrete without waterproof knee protection.
- Got it on your skin? Wash it off with clean water right away. Soaked clothes? Change them.

Ask the crew: "Who's got spare gloves, and where's the clean water today?"

02 EXCAVATIONS & TRENCH WALLS

DIG & FOOTINGS

A trench wall can let go in seconds, with no warning. A single cubic metre of soil weighs about as much as a small car.

- Anything over 1.2 m (4 ft) deep that workers go into needs protection: sloping, benching or shoring. Follow WorkSafeBC and your engineer.
- Keep spoil piles, materials and machines back from the edge.
- Keep a ladder or safe way out within easy reach. Re-check the walls after rain or vibration.
- Never work in an excavation alone.

Ask the crew: "If this wall moves, where's our way out?"

03 REBAR: IMPALEMENT & TRIPS

FORMS & STEEL

Exposed vertical bars and loose tie wire cause some of the worst injuries on concrete sites, and trips and cuts happen every day.

- Cap or cover exposed vertical bars. Basic caps stop scrapes; where someone could fall onto bars, use **impalement-rated** caps or wood troughs.
- Keep walkways clear of offcuts, tie wire and bundles.
- Wear gloves for handling steel, and get a second person on heavy bundles.

Ask the crew: "Which bars on this site are uncapped right now?"

04 PUMP TRUCK, BOOM & POWER LINES

POUR DAYS

The boom, the hose and the lines overhead can all kill you, and they all move faster than you expect.

- Never stand under the boom. Know where the overhead lines are, and use a spotter to keep the boom outside WorkSafeBC limits of approach.
- Hose whip: stand clear of the hose end when pumping starts or stops and when a blockage is cleared.
- Agree hand signals and a clear stop signal with the operator **before** the first truck.

Ask the crew: "Who's our spotter, and what's the stop signal?"

05 SILICA DUST: CUTTING & GRINDING

ANY DAY

Cutting, grinding or drilling concrete releases crystalline silica. Breathing it causes silicosis and lung cancer, and the damage is permanent.

- Cut wet, or use tools with a shroud and a HEPA vacuum.
- Wear the respirator the job calls for, and make sure it fits.
- Don't dry-sweep dust; use water or a HEPA vac. Wash up before you eat.
- Your employer should have a silica exposure control plan. Ask to see it.

Ask the crew: "What are we cutting today, and how are we controlling the dust?"

TALK SIGN-IN

KEEP THIS SHEET AS YOUR RECORD

DATE	SITE	TALK #	LED BY

NAME	TRADE	SIGNATURE